

13 — Pre-rendering Effects

LIFECYCLE DOM

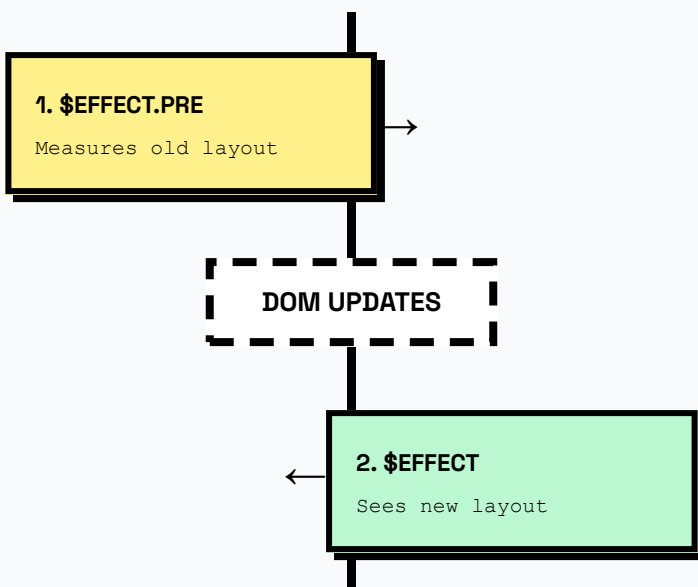
Q. How do you read layout dimensions or scroll positions immediately before the browser repaints the screen?

ANSWER. If you are building an auto-scrolling chat app, reading the scroll height during a normal `$effect` happens *after* the UI updates, causing a jarring visual flicker. You use the `$effect.pre` rune to measure layouts exactly a split-second *before* the browser repaints, allowing you to create butter-smooth UI adjustments.

Scroll.svelte

```
<script>
  let height = $state(0);

  $effect.pre(() => {
    // Runs BEFORE the DOM updates
    console.log("Old height:",
      document.body.scrollHeight);
  });
</script>
```



① **Summary.** `$effect.pre` fires right *before* the browser repaints the screen. This is critical because it lets you measure layouts or save scroll positions right before a UI shift happens. This allows you to create perfectly smooth animations and transitions.